Ask the Grown-Ups

Civic Skill: Voice & Participation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 5 (Communicating) & Outcome 2 (Community) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years

LEARNING INTENTION

Children will practise the idea that they can ask questions of, and give feedback to, the adults who make decisions about their setting, connecting their own consultation experience to real civic influence.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can think of a question I want to ask a decision-maker about our room.
- I can help write or draw a message to a grown-up in charge.
- I can explain why it matters that grown-ups ask children questions.

MATERIALS

- Paper and drawing materials for a group letter or poster
- A real, identified recipient who has agreed in advance to receive and respond to the children's message (e.g., the service director, a centre committee member, or local council contact)
- A 'message box' or envelope to seal and send the message

ACTIVITY STEPS

1. OPENING DISCUSSION (4 min): 'Who are the grown-ups who decide things about our room or our playground? Do you think they ask children what they think?'

2. BRAINSTORM (6 min): Children generate questions or messages they would like to send, for example: 'Can we have more time outside?' or 'We would like a new sandpit toy.'

3. GROUP MESSAGE (8 min): As a group, dictate or draw a shared letter or poster combining ideas, with the educator scribing the children's exact words.

4. SEND IT (3 min): Seal and arrange delivery of the message to the identified adult.

5. ANTICIPATE A REPLY (4 min): Discuss what might happen next, and plan to revisit once a response is received — this links directly to the 'Closing the Loop' session.

EXTENSIONS	ASSESSMENT
• Once a reply is received, hold a follow-up session to share and discuss it as a class • Explore other real decision-makers relevant to children's lives — a council, a library, a local park ranger • Keep a running 'Messages Sent' record over the term	• Note the substantiveness of the questions and messages children generate • Observe children's understanding of who holds decision-making power in their setting • Document the group message as a portfolio artefact of genuine civic participation

EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Was the recipient genuinely able to respond to, and act on, any part of the children's request? What did that teach the children about influence?
- How might this become a regular avenue for children's voice in your setting, rather than a one-off event?
- What did children's questions reveal about what matters most to them right now?

EYLF LINKS

This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 5 (Communicating) & Outcome 2 (Community). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.